

Epson Stylus C63

Smart impressions

This printer stands out from the rest of the crowd: try this little test. Take a printout from any inkjet printer and immediately pour water on it. Does the printout stay the same? It wouldn't. But it does with this printer. We actually tried it!

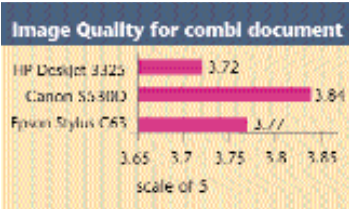
The printer has a small footprint, and will fit snugly on your desk. The interface is USB, but you also have the parallel port option. The paper feed tray is top-loading. There are three buttons on the top—one for the power, one for changing the ink cartridge, and one for cancelling a print.

The text printout was quite good; however, at lower font sizes, the dithering is pretty obvious. The photo quality was average; the overall image was dark, but contrast reproduction was very good. In the text with image printout, the results were quite good, indicating that this printer was built primarily to serve as a text



printer, with a sprinkling of images.

The Epson Stylus C63 retails for a competitive Rs 3,999. Going by the price-to-performance ratio, you can't go wrong with it.



SPECIFICATIONS

232 KB buffer RAM, 17 ppm, USB and parallel interface, paper types supported: A4 and letter sizes and special paper

Epson Stylus C63	
Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for money	★★★★

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HP LaserJet 1015

Hardly jet-set

The HP LaserJet 1015 is easily one of the most compact and lightweight laser printers available, tipping the scales at just 5.9 Kg. The printer body is dark blue in the front and silver-grey on the sides. The output paper



tray can't hold more than 25 sheets at a time. The input tray can hold up to 150 sheets, and 10 sheets can be lined up for manual feed.

The 1015 has 16 MB of non-upgradeable buffer memory. The user interface consists of a simple two-button combination, along with

three LEDs, to indicate the printer's operational status, as well as errors. The 1015 can connect to a PC through both the USB and parallel port interfaces—the cables aren't bundled.

Despite the 16 MB buffer, the 1015's performance was mediocre, especially while printing complex documents. The combo PDF document was printed in 19.2 seconds, but the quality of the printout was average. It scored even worse in the image test, with prominent banding seen throughout the printed photo. The printer did perform much better in the MS Word print tests, with

excellent quality and at good speeds.

The 1015 is targeted primarily at home and SoHo users. But, with its poor performance in printing complex documents, it can only be suitable for users with simple printing requirements. Even though the 1015 looks good on paper, the Rs 14,499 price tag is entirely unjustified.

SPECIFICATIONS

133 MHz RISC processor, 16 MB buffer, 14 ppm, USB 1.1/IEEE 1284, PCL 5/e and host-based drivers, media supported: A4, envelopes, transparencies, postcards

HP LaserJet 1015	
Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for money	★★★★

Logitech Cordless Click Plus

Just point and click

The Click Plus mouse is ergonomically shaped, albeit only for the right-handed. Its contours are slightly curved at the top, making it a little uncomfortable for people with small hands. The mouse looks good, with a blue and silver body, instead of the staid white or beige. The buttons themselves are very well calibrated, and respond very well too. Besides the standard right and left buttons and the mouse wheel, the mouse also features a tiny extra button just beneath the mouse wheel, and two thumb buttons on the sides—putting six buttons within easy reach. It can be operated up to 5 to 6 feet away from the receiver.

The Click Plus mouse performs very well, and is very precise in both movement and selection of objects

on the monitor. The scroll wheel's movement is slightly jerky, but definitely smoother than earlier Logitech mice.

The mouse is good for use with applications such as Photoshop and Microsoft Word, but



in our gaming test, it was a different story altogether. The mouse was oversensitive, with the crosshair all over the place; this isn't really a mouse meant for a gamer. Surprisingly, when we tested the mouse with newer games

SPECIFICATIONS

RF, optical sensing technology, PS/2 or USB interface for RF receiver, three extra customisable buttons, ergonomic design for right-handers, two AA batteries included.